

## PerlPrintable

```
#Student Name:Michia Rohrsen
#Program Name:HW 8 Problem 1
#Creation Date:4/22/2009
#Last Modified Date:4/22/2009
#COIN Course:COIN 333
#Grade Received:43/45
```

```
@months = qw(january february march april may june july august september october
november december);
```

```
foreach $month (@months)
```

```
{
    $cur = uc $month;
```

```
    if (($cur eq 'APRIL') or ($cur eq 'JUNE') or ($cur eq 'SEPTEMBER') or ($cur eq
'NOVEMBER'))
```

```
    {
        $month = 30;
```

```
    }
    elsif ($cur eq 'FEBRUARY')
```

```
    {
        $month = 28;
```

```
    }
    else {
        $month = 31;
```

```
    }
}
```

```
#test code
```

```
foreach $month (@months)
```

```
{
    print "$month\n";
}
```



**Ethics Paper Coin 217**

**Grade Received : 100**

Michia Rohrssen

COIN 217

November 13 2007

Ethics Paper

Today, copyright laws seem meaningless, as more and more people download music every day. Many people do it, and it is for the most part acknowledged similar to speeding, everyone does it. However, this does not excuse the fact that it is ultimately illegal. Downloading a few songs here and there is okay; similar to driving a little over the speed limit, but downloading full albums in excess is wrong. Downloading 500, 1,000, or even 10,000 songs is too many. I feel downloading a big hit that's on the radio is okay if you just want that song. If you really like it, go out and buy the album.

So, clearly there must be a line drawn where the piracy level is too high to go unpunished. The RIAA's seemingly random method of choosing its victims is almost as if a bunch of lawyers just throw darts at names on a wall. There is no reason why these people chosen over other were selected to be the new victims. The RIAA intends to make an example out of these few selected; hoping that these scare tactics will stop illegal downloads.

The article talks about two different students fined by the RIAA, Sarah Barg and Johnson. Sarah Barg downloaded 381 songs from her dorm using Ares, a P2P program. Sure she is wrong, but why Sarah? And then there is Johnson, who only downloaded 100 songs. Why did the RIAA choose these people? They are simple college students, just trying to get an education so they can support themselves and get a good job. They are no different from the millions of other people that download songs illegally every year, except for the fact that they are very easy targets.

Simply put, the RIAA's scare tactics and relentless bullying are awful. Charging a college student \$3000 for downloading songs is simply unethical. If the RIAA truly just wanted piracy to stop, they would send out letters warning students, stating the fines and penalties if they do not stop. Surely then the students would stop. Suing college students is simply a easy way to make money, as they are too poor to resist. The RIAA uses unethical tactics to bully those who cannot afford their ludicrous fines and charges. The RIAA surely enjoys all this piracy and thrives off of it. Last year the RIAA profited nearly \$100,000,000 just from file sharing lawsuits. The RIAA's lawsuits are not intended to bring about change, or stop music piracy. Rather, it uses it as an easy way to make money. They thrive on the defenseless, and charge unusually high fines in order to make money. I'd imagine they use all the profits they get from these lawsuits for nothing less than buying more lawyers. The RIAA is so intimidating law-wise, that no one can afford to resist them.

Copyright issues are a problem, but the RIAA is not handling them in a proper or responsible manner. Rather than bullying around college students, they should target those running the sites. These sites are the main source of the problem, so they should be the first target.

When the RIAA finds a student in violation of copyright laws, they should simply send them a official letter warning them that they have been caught, and that if the files are not erased and the illegal activities stopped, action will be taken against them. I believe this would be a more reasonable punishment, since the way that the RIAA currently deals with students is simply unethical.

**Ethics Paper COIN 325**

**Grade Received: 100**

Michia Rohrsen

Java II

11/10/09

### Hate Email Ethics Paper

The line between free speech and criminal activity is certainly a grey area in our society. We parade the idea of free speech as a justification, and preach the message of "all men are created equal." While all men are created equal, not all men are *treated* equal. Take the case of Richard Machado. Imagine for a second if a similar email was sent to a judge right before a very large criminal case. Or an even more extreme example, an email to the White House threatening Obama. Surely these would receive immediate attention and would be investigated to the highest level. On contrast, if Jessica send's an email to Brittany threatening to kill her for stealing Jessica's ex-boyfriend Bobby, chances are a small investigation at most would be required.

Obviously this ideal of "free speech" can never fully be realized, and even limited versions come with a steep price. For example Richard Machado spent a year in prison over an email threatening Asians, while Neo-Nazi groups protested freely just last week in Arizona, November 8<sup>th</sup>(UPI). So the truth is, there is no line that can be drawn between free speech and criminal activity. No such line ever existed, nor will it ever exist. When it comes to free speech, it is not the act that determines legality, but the circumstances surrounding it. As I mentioned earlier, threatening the president is a clear felony, whereas spamming hate email to a particular race is a gray area at best. While it may not be a true threat, it is certainly a hate crime and should be investigated as such. Obviously it is the schools responsibility to report all campus crimes to the police, and then the police are obligated to follow up with an investigation if deemed necessary.

Because of all this moral and legal ambiguity, there can never be a true cut and clear definition of free speech vs. criminal activity. Each case must be investigated individually. This is exactly why our legal system works through a Jury, and not solely through the judgment of one person. In this particular case, I do not feel that the location of the crime would have determined the ramifications Machado faced. Just like killing someone on a bridge does not make it anything less than murder, a hate crime in an internet café is still a hate crime. As for targeting and entire race, it simply changes the crime. Had Machado targeted a single person, it would have been taken to court as a violent threat. However, since he targeted people based on race, it becomes a hate crime. Again, this goes back to my point of each case requiring individual evaluation and investigation.

Morally speaking, what Machado did was very clearly wrong. As Ephesians 4: 29 says: "Do not let any unwholesome talk come out of your mouths, but only what is helpful for building others up according to their needs, that it may benefit those who listen"(The New English Bible). Even the ACM, a completely secular code of computing ethics states "Discrimination on the basis of race, sex, religion, age, disability, national origin, or other such factors is an explicit violation of ACM policy and will not be tolerated"(ACM). Clearly Machado was in direct violation of this in his hate email. His words were harsh

and cruel, and revealed him to be someone with poor character. These are traits that directly contrast the Christian model of living, which is that of Jesus Christ.

However, what about a Christian Institution such as Charleston Southern? Would a Christian University have different obligations in a case such as this compared to a public university? Legally speaking, they would not. The law does not change based on where the crime is committed, and a case such as this is tried by a court of law. However, a Christian Universities do have extra obligations to uphold there good name as a school with God's presence. The Bible tells us that we must not only be right in God's eyes, but that we must be seen as pure in the eyes of others. This is the same reason priests do not frequent bars, even if they would not be drinking. They must uphold the image of Godliness to others. They must be a shining example. For this same reason, Christian Universities should be expected to take extra measures to ensure that their reputation and image is not tarnished by activities that happen on campus. They are also allowed to do this, since Christian Universities are a private institution and therefore not constrained by some of the laws that govern public institutions.

As I said earlier, legal and moral guidelines for free speech are not cut in stone. Each case must be evaluated and handled on and individual basis. Furthermore, in the case of Christian facilities, they should be expected to uphold a higher sense of morality and justice in order to not tarnish the Lords name.

#### Works Cited

"Code of Ethics ." *ACM*. 16 Oct 1992. ACM, Web. 10 Nov 2009. <<http://www.acm.org/about/code-of-ethics>>.

"Neo-Nazi group protests in Phoenix." *UPI*. 08 NOV 2009. UPI, Web. 10 Nov 2009. <[http://www.upi.com/Top\\_News/US/2009/11/08/Neo-Nazi-group-protests-in-Phoenix/UPI-71901257707608/](http://www.upi.com/Top_News/US/2009/11/08/Neo-Nazi-group-protests-in-Phoenix/UPI-71901257707608/)>.

*The New English Bible*. NY: Oxford University Press, 2007.



**Ethics Paper COIN 333**

**Grade Received: 90**



Michia Rohrsen

Gary Underwood

COIN 333

8 September 2009

### Microsoft's Legal Conflict

Early August 2009, a Texas court ruled that Microsoft must stop selling Microsoft Word by October 10 2009 or pay over \$290 million dollars in damages(Gohring). The lawsuit states that Microsoft's document program "Word" infringes a patent held by a small Canadian company known as i4i inc. According to i4i Microsoft knowingly used a patented method of developing custom XML tables that was originally sold as an add-on by i4i inc.

Since the addition of this feature into Word, i4i inc claims that their business has dropped significantly, and they are blaming it on Microsoft. This actually makes a lot of sense, because if a program has a function already built in, there would be no need for the add-on to even exist.

This is a very serious legal issue because a company that relies on the sales of add-ons is essentially bankrupted by a large corporation such as Microsoft adding the same functionality from within the existing program. Lost sales and wages must be taken into account. Particularly in this case, Microsoft is charged with willful infringement, so i4i inc. has a very legitimate argument.

However, the entire case hinges on the question of whether or not Microsoft knowingly infringed on the patent. If Microsoft was unaware of the patent, then it would be very hard to legally or ethically to hold them responsible.

Most projects Microsoft handles are coded by many different teams. Certain teams each have their own responsibilities, and then the final product is put together as one program. If they outsource the coding, this adds even more factors to the production. So by the time a program reaches finalization, it will have many different programmers contributing to its source. One programmer may have knowingly infringed on the i4i inc. copyright, but it is highly unlikely that the administration of Microsoft was aware of this.

So in that aspect, I do not believe Microsoft was wrong in adding this functionality to their program. They most likely were unaware of the infringement.

However, now that the issue has been brought to light, I believe Microsoft should be forced to do two things. First off, it should have to pay for damages unintentionally caused. I think \$290+ million dollars is a bit extreme for lost wages of a small software company, but the company certainly deserves compensation for lost wages and a small amount of future wages.

After that, Microsoft should have a fixed time period, perhaps 1 month, to develop a

replacement to add similar functionality that does not infringe on the patent. This would then have to be distributed through an automatic update through either Word or Windows.

If no such replacement exists, then Microsoft would have to disable the function in current versions of Word. This could be done through a required auto update either through Windows or Word itself.

Obviously doing this would negatively affect the functionality of Word, so Microsoft would be obligated to release a notice after the update installs letting users know of the changes and why they are required. This would take care of all previous versions as well as current and future versions of Word. While this option may offend consumers, it may be the only choice that would allow them to still legally use Microsoft Word.

The final alternative Microsoft should have available is to buy the patent and any related software from i4i inc. Obviously i4i inc would be reluctant to hand over this part of its business, so it would be up to Microsoft to weigh the cost of buying the patent vs. lost wages and damages by removing the functionality from existing software.

If none of these solutions are able to work many serious consequences would result from a ban. However, if this is the only option left then the Judge does not have any other option but to order a ban. This could potentially cause vast amounts of damage to our economy, as well as day to day activities. First and foremost would be the impact on businesses that rely on Microsoft Word. Many businesses we rely on day to day would be shut down as they adjust to a new system for word processing. Next would be the consumer, who uses and relies on Microsoft Word for day to day tasks. Millions of people would be forced to adjust to a new alternative program for Word processing.

Unfortunately, there are not very many good alternatives. The main free ones, OpenOffice and WordPad both have many downfalls. WordPad for example, is not very powerful and cannot be used to do many of the tasks Word can. OpenOffice also lacks a lot of functionality that Word offers. Even worse, the GUI is nowhere near as refined or user friendly as Word. Other options such as WordPerfect use file formats that are not easily opened or recognized by most programs. So when it comes to alternatives, there is no good option.

With all of these different problems relating to the legality and morality of Microsoft's patent infringement, it is obvious that the legal system must be involved. With such large sums of money at stake, even if Microsoft had simply agreed to rewrite the software and come to a settlement from the beginning, this would still have to go through the legal system.

At the current date of September 8<sup>th</sup>, the ban has been uplifted and Microsoft is still allowed to sell its products (Eaton). Microsoft was able to achieve this by arguing that the ban of Microsoft Word would have a devastating impact on businesses all over the world, and not just Microsoft. However, Microsoft must present its case on the matter September 23 2009 or the ban may be reinstated.

Microsoft clearly plans to fight the lawsuit. Only time will tell what the future of Word will be.

## Works Cited

Eaton, Nick. "Court grants Microsoft's motion to stay Word injunction." *Seattle Pi*. 4 September

2009. 8 Sep 2009 <<http://blog.seattlepi.com/microsoft/archives/178292.asp>>.

Gohring, Nancy. "Injunction On Microsoft Word Unlikely To Halt Sales." *ARN*. 12 August 2009.

8 Sep 2009<[http://www.arnnet.com.au/article/314620/injunction\\_microsoft\\_word\\_unlikely\\_halt\\_sales](http://www.arnnet.com.au/article/314620/injunction_microsoft_word_unlikely_halt_sales)>.

**Presentation: COIN 315**

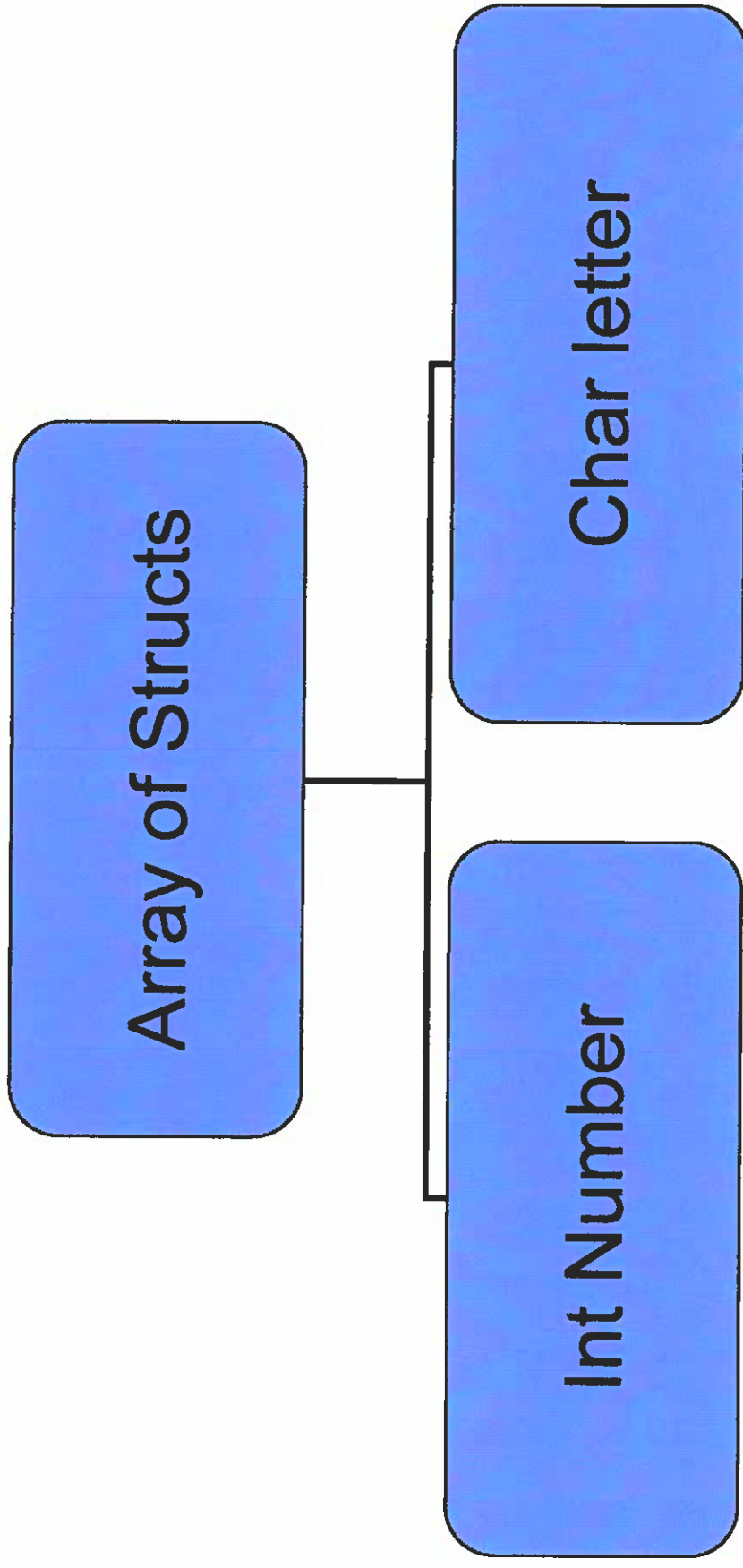
**Grade Received: N/A**



# Steps That Must Be Taken

- Store The Dictionary
- Store the Phrase
- Search the Dictionary
- Speed Tweaks

# Storing The Phrase





# Searching The Dictionary

- Using recursive backtracking algorithm.
  - Once word is built, check to see if all words have been used before by checking boolean “used”
  - If all words have been used, remove the last added word and try again.
  - If all words have not been used, set all words to “used,” store the word, and then backtrack.



# Speed Tweaks

- Using the boolean “used” to avoid removing duplicates later on.
- Using templated char vectors to allow ++, -, and begin and end iterators. This will also make data easier to manage.
- Data sorted by # of letters or alphabetically. Note: This would require an extra string of the full word.





**Presentation: COIN 497**

**Grade Received: N/A**

# Automated Sales Machine

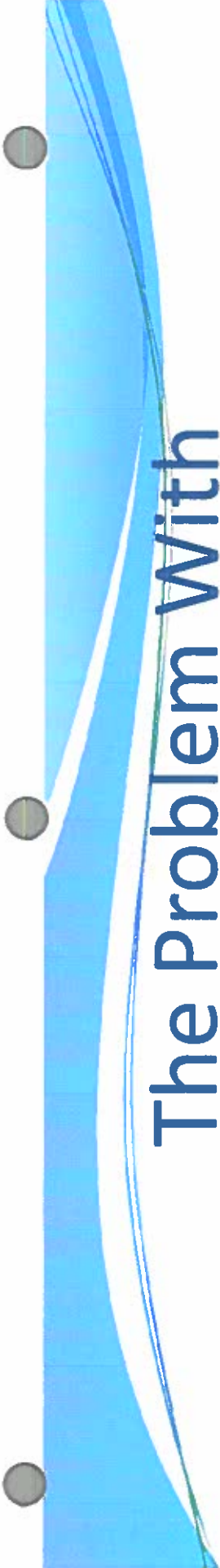
By Michia Rohrsen  
Advisor: Dr. Lin



# The Typical Web Marketing

## Sales Model

- Once every few months a “sale” is run offering the customer a special discount.
- This sale is broadcasted to the entire list of email subscribers.
- Prices are manually adjusted and then raised back up at the end of the sale.
- During the sale, daily profits generally increase 30-70%



# The Problem With Traditional Web Sales

- Sales are a great way to earn extra revenue.
- But they present many problems:
  - It's hard to properly time the sales...
    - Early sales immediately lower the perceived value of your product.
  - It's impossible to automate sales...
    - You have to setup the page, set the offer to expire, promote the sale.
  - Running a sale too often lowers the value of your product
    - Ideally you'd run a sale every couple weeks, but it can actually make your customer less likely to buy.



# The Solution:

## Automated Sales machine

- Automated sales machine makes sure that each subscriber receives the promotion at the exact right time for them.
  - I.E. My average customer buys after 28 days...so I'd set my sale to run only after they've been on my list for around 35 days or so.
- In doing so, it automatically creates a special page just for them and emails it to them. The page contains the sale, and will expire a set number of days after creation.
- Once the sale is sent to the user, they will never see the sale again, unless you set it to.
  - Sales can be set to repeat every X amount of days.

# Visual Model of a 4 Day Sale On

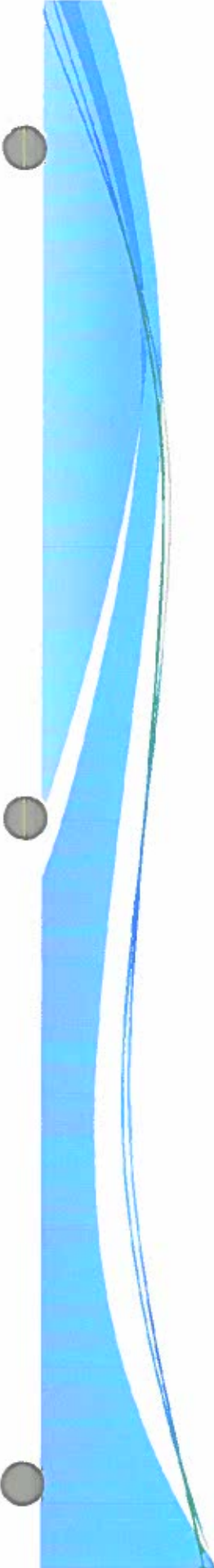
## A 180 Day Repeat Cycle

Signed up 17  
days ago, no  
sale yet

Signed up  
35 days ago,  
sale has just  
Started

Signed up  
40 days ago,  
sale has just  
expired

Signed up  
219 days  
ago, sale has  
just started



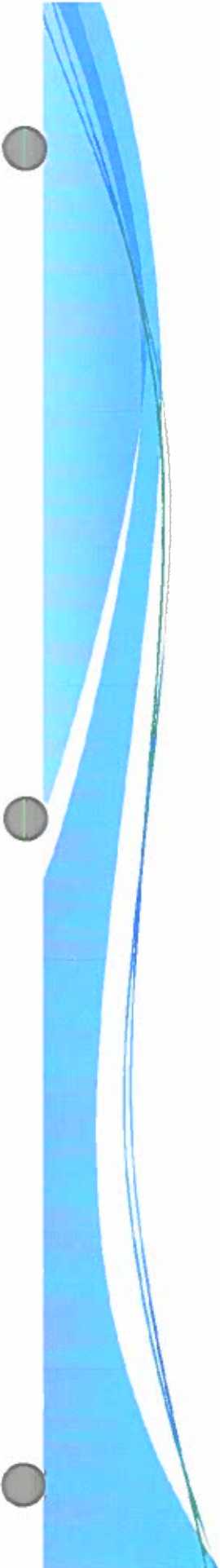
# How A.S.M Does This

- **Step 1:** When the lead is captured through an optin form on your website, A.S.M. stores this lead in a database.
- **Step 2:** The database is checked daily to see if any users have reached the set number of days for the sale.
- **Step 3:** The database creates a unique sales page for those users. This unique page will auto expire after a set number of days.
- **Step 4:** A.S.M. emails each user telling them about the sale, and warns them that it will expire in X number of days.
- **Step 5:** Statistics are tracked on the users response to the sale.
- **Step 6:** In X number of days the sales page is deleted.
- **Step 7:** Steps 3-6 will be repeated every X number of days.



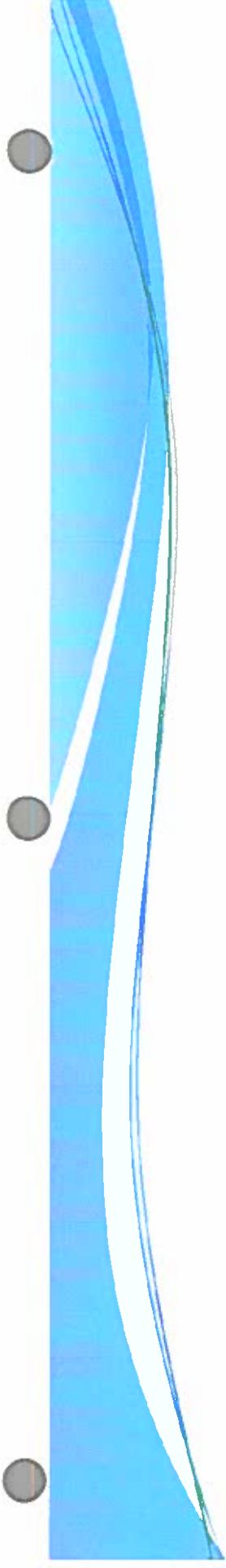






# My Timeline

- 1 Month design and planning.
- 1 Month coding the basic scripts to run the program.
- 2 Months designing and coding the backend GUI.
- 1 Month integrating the system into a real website.
- 1 Month bug testing and repairing.



# My Progress So Far

- Spent a lot of time collecting data from other web marketers on ideas they would like to see implemented and features they would want most.
- Since then I've been busy designing the functions, adding features, and designing the databases it will use.